
Cloud Migration Checklist

Work through this before your first conversation with any provider — it's the difference between a scoped project and one that quietly grows in cost and timeline.

BEFORE YOU CALL ANYONE

☐ **Inventory everything you actually run.** Every server, app, and forgotten internal tool — not just the obvious systems.

☐ **Write down what "done" means.** Specific systems, specific platform, specific date — not "move everything to the cloud."

☐ **Decide your security requirements up front.** Who needs access to what, and what compliance rules apply to your data.

☐ **Know your downtime tolerance.** Two hours on a Sunday, or every minute costs money? This changes the whole strategy.

☐ **Decide who owns the environment after go-live.** Your team, the provider, or a mix — agree this before signing, not after.

QUESTIONS TO ASK ANY PROVIDER QUOTING YOU

☐ What exactly is included, and what triggers extra cost?

☐ What happens if an unlisted system needs migrating too?

☐ What's the realistic timeline, and what could push it out?

☐ Who owns the environment after go-live — us or you?

☐ What does rollback look like if something breaks mid-migration?

☐ Have you migrated a business our size before?

RULE OF THUMB ON TIMELINE

☐ A well-scoped migration for a handful of core systems should run **weeks, not six-to-twelve months**. If a small migration gets an enterprise-length timeline, the quote is likely sized for a bigger company than yours.
